ExifTool Installation on Windows

A concise guide to installing ExifTool and running it from any terminal.

1. Download ExifTool

Visit the official ExifTool website https://exiftool.org/ and download the standalone Windows Executable ZIP package.
Check: The ZIP file appears in your Downloads folder.

2. Extract and rename

Right-click the ZIP file and choose **Extract All**. In the extracted folder, rename **exiftool(-k).exe** to **exiftool.exe**. Keep the **exiftool_files** folder.
Check: You have exiftool.exe and exiftool_files.

3. Move the files

Create **C:\Program Files\ExifTool**. Move both **exiftool.exe** and the **exiftool_files** folder into it. Approve the administrator prompt if Windows asks.
Check: Both items are inside C:\Program Files\ExifTool.

4. Add ExifTool to PATH

Press **Win + R**, enter **sysdm.cpl**, then press Enter. Select **Advanced** → **Environment Variables**. Under **User variables**, select **Path** → **Edit** → **New**. Add:
`C:\Program Files\ExifTool`
Click OK on all windows.

```
C:\Program Files\ExifTool
```

5. Refresh and test

Close open Command Prompt or PowerShell windows, then open a new one. Run:

```
exiftool -ver
```

Success: ExifTool displays its version number.

Note: PATH changes apply to newly opened terminals. If the command is not recognised, check that the folder path is correct and that exiftool.exe is inside it. Turn Off Windows Smart App Control